FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Issue 005 Tuesday, October 13, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

Build & Renovate

Roofing · Restoration · Garage Door · Exteriors · General Contracting · Home Building

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

TRADE

Hurricane Isaias hit Destin, Florida, as a Category 2 on October 9, and Cotality puts insured wind and surge losses at $2 billion to $3 billion.

Isaias made landfall near Destin at about 8:30 p.m. CDT on Friday, October 9, with eyewall winds near 105 mph, after reaching 120 mph as a Category 3 that morning. It is the season's first hurricane, the fourth named storm to reach U.S. landfall this year and the strongest.

Roofs failed first. Part of a hotel roof tore off in Pensacola, and a convenience store in East Milton lost its roof and a rear wall. Florida Realtors reported that some of the hardest-hit areas were in Santa Rosa County, particularly Milton and rural communities to the north, and in East Milton residents dealt with downed trees. Hundreds of thousands of customers in Alabama and the Panhandle lost power.

Cotality puts insured losses from wind and surge at $2 billion to $3 billion, mostly in the Panhandle and southern Alabama. Before landfall it counted about 777,000 homes in eight warning counties at moderate-or-greater wind risk, 353,000 of them in Escambia, Santa Rosa, Okaloosa and Walton counties. Those are exposure counts at full rebuild value, not loss estimates.

The governor's emergency order stood at 27 counties by Saturday, October 10. Alabama Power said it was bringing more than 5,000 added crews from nearly 25 states. Expect tarping, tree removal and water mitigation to lead, with permanent roof and exterior work following as power and adjusters arrive.

What to do about it: Price every storm job off a written price list dated before October 9, and keep a copy; Florida's gouging law, covered in the Roofing section, applies while the emergency stands. Photograph each roof and room before and after work, and get the customer's signature on scope before you tarp or tear off. Before you send crews, ask each county what license and local registration it requires, and tell customers to check credentials before they sign. Give customers the state insurance helpline, 1-877-693-5236, and get the adjuster's name and claim number in writing before you order material. If your own yard, trucks or leased space were hit, the state's zero-interest bridge loan closes November 25 or when funds run out; see General Contracting. Cotality's range comes from one modeler, so treat it as a range, not a ceiling.

Cotality: Hurricane Isaias targets the northern Gulf Coast · WALA/FOX Carolina: Isaias leaves 2 dead, outages · Florida Realtors: Hurricane Isaias recovery resources

ROOFING

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

A Verisk analysis found the average U.S. roof replacement cost 33% more in 2025 than the prior four-year average, and Bay News 9 reports the average is projected to rise a further 4% to 6% this year.

Why it matters: Bay News 9 (Sept 28) reported the 33% gap and the 4% to 6% projection, and named the drivers: petroleum-based shingles, metal, imported materials and freight. A Tampa roofer said his firm is holding prices for now but absorbing some increases, which thins margin on every signed bid. Exposed: any roofer carrying fixed-price bids written months ago, especially on storm work being quoted now. Do this week: reprice open bids at today's supplier lists, add a material-escalation clause with an expiry date to every new quote, and compare your last ten jobs' margin to the quote.

Bay News 9: Rising roofing costs pressure contractors

REGULATION

Florida's price-gouging law names roof repair, water remediation, tree removal and lumber during the Isaias emergency, with penalties of $1,000 per violation and up to $25,000 a day.

Why it matters: Florida's attorney general said on October 10 that unconscionable increases in essential commodities are barred while a state of emergency is declared. The covered list includes lumber, roof repair, water remediation and tree removal. The emergency covered 25 counties on October 10 and 27 after Saturday's expansion. Exposed: any Florida roofer, remediator or supplier repricing storm work; check your county against the emergency list. Do this week: freeze your price list at its pre-storm date, keep invoices that show material cost and markup, and report scammers at myfloridalegal.com or 1-866-966-7226.

News4JAX: Attorney general warns of gouging, repair scams · Florida Realtors: Hurricane Isaias recovery resources

RESTORATION

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Cotality counts about 342,000 homes in the Storm Surge Warning area, from Louisiana to Florida, at moderate-or-greater surge risk, with a rebuild value of $101.5 billion.

Why it matters: Surge puts water in homes that wind never touches. Cotality's October 9 update puts about 78,000 homes in Escambia, Santa Rosa, Okaloosa and Walton counties at surge risk; its October 8 counts had Bay County, Florida near 43,000, Jackson County, Mississippi near 40,000 and Baldwin County, Alabama near 35,000. These are exposure counts at full rebuild value, not losses, and the modeler's insured-loss estimate is $2 billion to $3 billion. Exposed: firms within a day's drive of the Panhandle and Mobile Bay. Do this week: confirm drying equipment, crews and a moisture-mapping log, and put written pricing in front of every customer before work starts.

Cotality: Hurricane Isaias targets the northern Gulf Coast

INSURANCE

Florida's Division of Consumer Services has contacted 60 insurers to set up post-storm assistance hubs, and a state claims line, 1-877-693-5236, is open for home, condo and auto damage.

Why it matters: Insurer hubs speed adjuster contact, which sets when approved scopes and payments reach you. The state also has two criminal-investigation teams accompanying more than 475 search-and-rescue members, and the attorney general warned that scam texts offer tree service "in coordination with your insurance company." Expect customers to ask you to prove you are not one of them. Exposed: restorers working claims in the Panhandle. Do this week: get the adjuster's name and claim number in writing before you start, send pre-mitigation photos with each estimate, and check dcnonline.org, the state-supported directory homeowners use to find repair contractors.

Florida CFO: Isaias preparedness efforts · Florida Realtors: Hurricane Isaias recovery resources · News4JAX: Attorney general warns of gouging, repair scams

GARAGE DOOR

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

DASMA's Fall 2026 Tech Corner says storm-door impact tests use a 9-pound 2x4 at 50 feet per second, or 80 for Risk Category III and IV structures in the fastest wind regions.

Why it matters: Windborne-debris regions require impact-rated exterior doors under ASTM E1886 and E1996 or ANSI/DASMA 115; Florida's high-velocity zone uses TAS 201. The 80 feet per second test applies to Risk Category III and IV buildings in winds above about 150 mph. Usually only glazed doors must comply, except in Miami-Dade and Broward, where every exterior door must. Storm shelters follow ICC 500, with a 15-pound 2×4 at up to 100 mph. Replacement quotes after Isaias turn on this question. DASMA's Fall 2026 column carries no publication date. Do this week: ask the building department whether the address is in a windborne-debris region before you quote, and keep the product test report in the job file.

DASMA Tech Corner, Fall 2026: Impact testing for doors

DEMAND

KKR plans to buy A1 Garage Door Service, a Phoenix repair and installation firm founded in 2007, for about $2 billion, according to a September 3 24/7 Wall St. report relayed in DASMA's fall clippings.

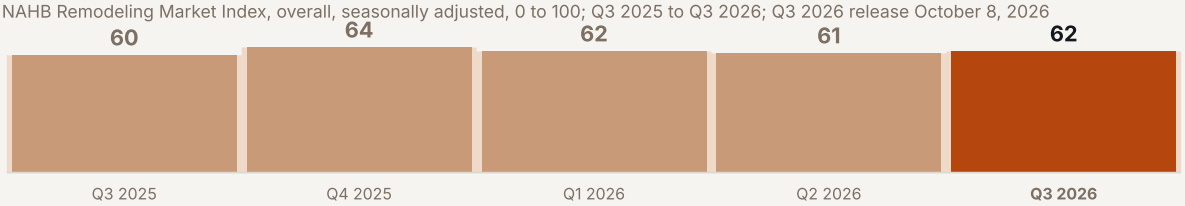
Why it matters: DASMA's Fall 2026 Clippings, citing a September 3 24/7 Wall St. report, says KKR plans to acquire A1, which Cortec Group has backed since 2022. KKR's earlier home-services deals include Neighborly in 2021 and Groundworks in 2023. The price shows what private equity will pay for a scaled service business, not what a small shop is worth. It was reported September 3 and rests on that one report. Do this week: if a sale is on your horizon, pull three years of financials and a count of recurring service accounts, and watch for roll-up offers to your technicians.

DASMA Clippings, Fall 2026

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / REMODELER SENTIMENT

NAHB's remodeling index has stayed within a 60-to-64 band for five quarters and ended at 62 in the third quarter of 2026.

NAHB Remodeling Market Index, overall, seasonally adjusted, 0 to 100; Q3 2025 to Q3 2026; Q3 2026 release October 8, 2026



Above 50, more remodelers rate conditions good than poor. The low in the last 13 quarters was 59, in Q2 2025. Backlog (56) and leads (53) are above 50, and the overall index sits far below its 2021 readings of 83 to 87, so this is a steady market, not a surge. Plan crews for steady volume and watch the lead count first. NAHB Remodeling Market Index full report, Q3 2026

EXTERIORS

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

Henkel's polyurethane and solvent sealants and butyl flash rise November 1, while Tamlyn's house wrap went up about 10% on September 16 and NPC's full line 8% to 9% on September 20.

Why it matters: Universal Supply's October update lists Henkel's November 1 increase on polyurethane adhesives and sealants (not foam), solvent adhesives and sealants, select butyl tape and butyl flash; the percentage is not published. Its September update lists TamlynWrap Elite up about 10% and XtremeTrim about 8% from September 16, and its October update NPC, all products, up about 8% to 9% from September 20. Exposed: siding, window and door installers, whose flashing, sealant and trim lines all moved. Do this week: ask your supplier for the Henkel percentage, buy flashing and sealant before November 1, and date-limit open quotes written at old prices.

Universal Supply: October Monthly Update · Universal Supply: September Monthly Update

SUPPLY

Mastic raised vinyl siding, accessories and PVC trim about 5% on August 1, Garden State Lumber's NuCedar shingle about 5% the same day, and Velux, all products, about 3% on August 17.

Why it matters: Universal Supply's August update lists increases that have reached vinyl, PVC trim, cedar shingle and skylights. REEB's Therma-Tru entry doors rose about 3% to 6% and Fypon millwork about 5% from August 10. These increases took effect August 1 to August 17, and the supplier's page shows no publish date. Exposed: exterior remodelers quoting siding and trim jobs on spring price lists. Do this week: re-run your two most common siding and trim bids at current list and add an escalation clause.

Universal Supply: August Monthly Update

GENERAL CONTRACTING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

NAHB's remodeling index rose one point to 62 in the third quarter as large-project sentiment rose two points to 66 while moderate and small jobs slipped, and the West trailed at 56.

Why it matters: NAHB (Oct 8; 242 responses) has current conditions flat at 70 for a third quarter and future indicators up two to 54, with backlog at 56 and leads at 53. Large jobs ($50,000 and up) rose to 66; moderate jobs ($20,000 to $49,999) fell to 71 and small jobs (under $20,000) to 73. By region the Northeast reads 68, Midwest 64, South 61 and West 56; above 50 means more remodelers see conditions as good than poor. Exposed: GCs whose pipeline is mid-size kitchen and addition work. Do this week: compare your own lead count and backlog to NAHB's 53 and 56, and push large-project bids.

NAHB: Remodeling market sentiment stable in Q3 · NAHB Remodeling Market Index full report, Q3 2026

MONEY

Florida's $10 million Small Business Emergency Bridge Loan offers zero-interest loans up to $100,000 to storm-damaged businesses, including sole proprietors, and applications close November 25 or when funds run out.

Why it matters: FloridaCommerce's program covers businesses with physical damage or economic losses, and the loans are short-term and must be repaid. A contractor whose yard, trucks or leased space were hit, or whose jobs slipped, can apply at floridajobs.org/DisasterRecovery/EBL or call 833-832-4494; the Private Sector Hotline is 850-815-4925, daily 7 a.m. to 7 p.m. Exposed: contractors in the 27 emergency counties. The details come from Florida Realtors; confirm terms with the state program before applying. Do this week: document damage with photos and invoices, then call the hotline before the funds run out.

Florida Realtors: Hurricane Isaias recovery resources

HOME BUILDING

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

NAHB's July survey found builders' material costs up a median 6.7% in a year, with builders starting five or fewer homes at 9.1% and builders starting 100 or more at 1.8%.

Why it matters: 72.9% of builders reported increases of up to 15%; 28.4% reported 5% to 9.99%, the most common band, and 22.1% reported 10% to 14.99%. The producer price index for goods used in new residential construction rose 6.7% including energy and 5.0% without it. The 7.3-point gap by size suggests buying power matters. The survey was conducted in early July 2026. Exposed: small builders without volume programs. Do this week: ask your two largest suppliers for program pricing, price lots at today's cost, and lock framing packages when you sign.

NAHB Eye on Housing: Cost of materials rises

LABOR

NAHB says labor shortages and data center competition are lengthening remodeling timelines, while remodeling gains share of construction because it is less sensitive to elevated rates than new building.

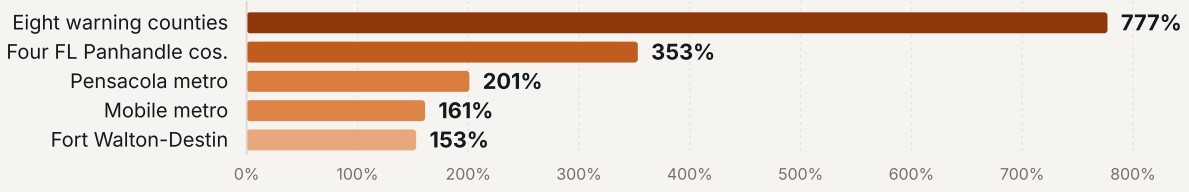
Why it matters: NAHB's October 8 release says shortages are stretching project schedules in some regions and that some customers are hesitant to start projects. It projects stable remodeling activity in 2026 and slight growth in 2027. HousingWire (Oct 9) notes the index has stayed between 59 and 70 for four years. Exposed: builders who compete with data center work for trades. Do this week: get firm start dates from your three busiest subs in writing, add schedule-slip language to new contracts, and price a remodel line for past buyers if your own starts have slowed.

NAHB: Remodeling market sentiment stable in Q3 · HousingWire: Q3 2026 NAHB remodeler sentiment

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / WIND EXPOSURE

About 777,000 homes in eight warning counties faced moderate-or-greater wind-damage risk from Isaias, 353,000 of them in four Panhandle counties.

Homes at moderate-or-greater wind-damage risk, thousands; Cotality Hazard HQ updates of October 8 to 10, 2026 (page updated October 12); rows overlap and do not add

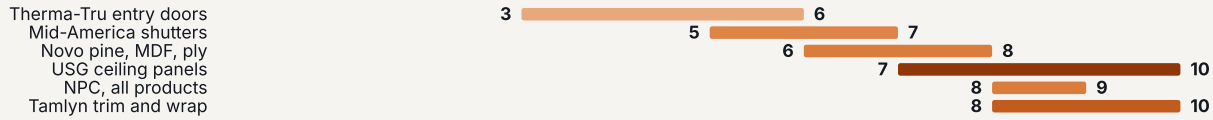


These count houses in the path at full rebuild value; they are not damage counts. Cotality's own insured-loss estimate after landfall is $2 billion to $3 billion. Use the chart to size a market: Pensacola alone holds about 201,000 exposed homes, and the Destin metro 153,000. Cotality: Hurricane Isaias targets the northern Gulf Coast

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / PRICE NOTICES

Exterior and trim makers announced increases of 3% to 10% between August 10 and September 20, with Tamlyn's trim and wrap and USG's ceiling panels topping out at 10%.

Announced increase ranges (about), percent, by manufacturer line; Universal Supply monthly updates: https://www.universalsupply.com/august-monthly-update-4/ , https://www.universalsupply.com/september-monthly-update-6/ and https://www.universalsupply.com/october-monthly-update-6/ ; effective August 10 to September 20



Every line moved by at least 3%, and four of six lines top out at 8% or more. Henkel's November 1 sealant increase is not charted because its percentage is not published. Compare these against the material line in your open bids and reprice any quote written before August. Universal Supply: September Monthly Update

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

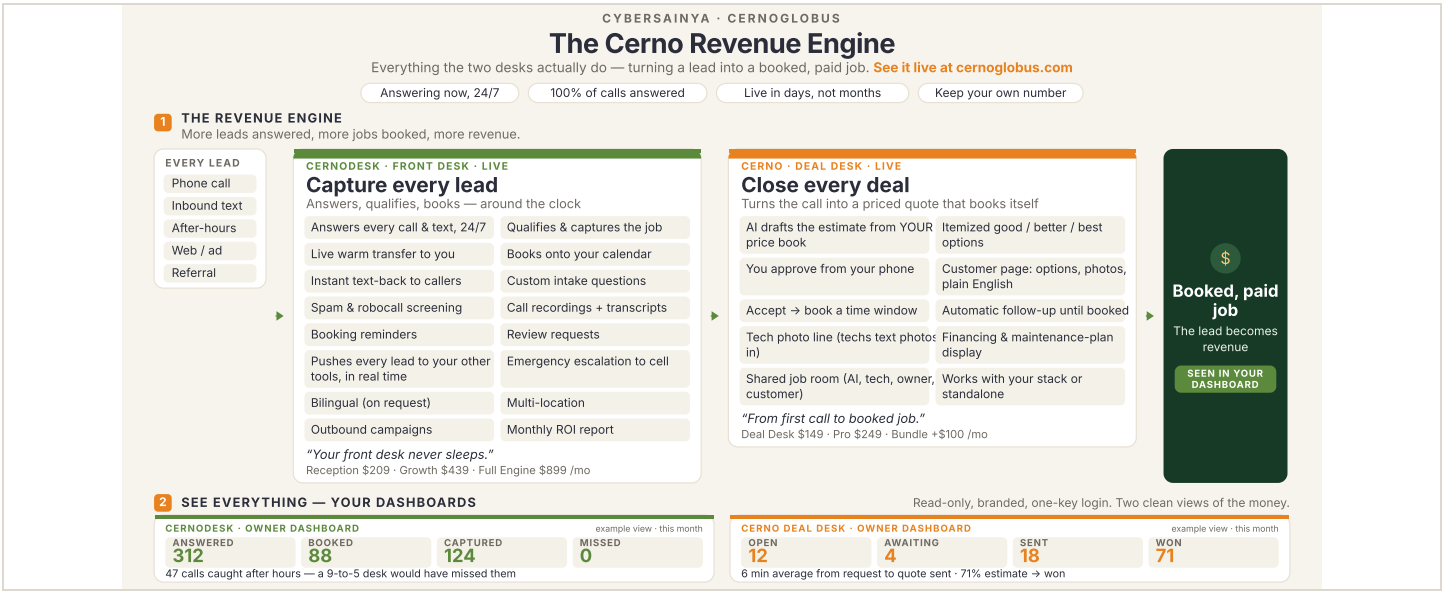
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a builder or remodeler. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails bids, change orders and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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